

CHAPTER 3: TIMING AND RULES OVERVIEW

The game is divided into Closed Play (where only specific cards and abilities can be used) and Open Play. Because Open Play is mostly simultaneous, it uses Offensive Effect rules to organise it.

Definition: Closed Play

A period of the game where only specific plays can be made

During closed play, use the rules specified in chapter 2 or the combat section. You can only play cards or abilities as allowed by those rules, where specified on the card or to cancel a card used by an opponent.

Definition: Open Play

A period of the game where Open Play cards and abilities can be used. Not Closed Play. Open play defines effects as Offensive or non-offensive.

Definition: Offensive Effect

1. For members of a pack: any card or ability which could affect a card in the Hunting Grounds or another pack, including Unique cards (e.g. *Body Wrack*, *Spiritual Revelation*).
2. For creatures in the Hunting Grounds: any card or ability which does not target the creature that played it.

3.1 TIMING ETIQUETTE

Most Rage games pass too quickly to be absolutely thorough with your timing. However, if you do play an Offensive Effect without following correct timing procedure - especially if you do not have their attention - they are well within their rights to say, "Woah..." and play stuff on their own pack. Similarly, if a player moves between Open Play and Closed Play before you are ready, you can ask them to take their actions back. Consistently leaping ahead when your opponents are not ready could be taken as cheating (although generally **Rage** is a friendly game).

It is bad etiquette, if another player asks if you are ready for him to play an Offensive Effect, to stay silent: if you are thinking, you should say so. Nor should you disturb your opponent if they are clearly playing cards or using abilities at the time.

3.1.2 OOPS...

If a situation occurs in which a past play condition would have been affected by something a player of Character has in play but failed to take into consideration, TOO BAD. For example, another player plays a Gift on one of your characters and you both forgot Dead Zone was out. If you realize next turn that you couldn't have been affected by that Gift, too bad. If you didn't catch it at the time it happened, continue on with game and don't try to back track to "fix" this misplay.

3.2 OPEN PLAY AND CLOSED PLAY

Closed Play is a period of play in which most cards and abilities cannot be used. All other periods of time are Open Play. During Closed Play only the following cards and abilities can be used:

- Cards playable according to the rules (e.g. Resources, Combat Actions);
- Cards in play whose ability is always active (e.g. Weapons, *Survivor*);
- Abilities which are triggered by the effects of the Closed Play (e.g. *Medicine Bag*);
- Cards which negate other cards or abilities played (e.g. Gift cancellation, Iron Will);
- Cards or abilities who override timing rules with their text (e.g. Distractions, No Escape).

Each phase starts with a period of Closed Play. There is no Open Play in the phase before these periods of Closed Play. Steps 1-6 of each combat round are Closed Play and the Declaration and Pre-Combat steps during combat declaration are also Closed Play.

Any period of play which is not Closed Play is Open Play.

3.2.1 OPEN PLAY TIMING

During Open Play, you may play sept cards or use the abilities on sept and character cards at any time it is appropriate (according to the card type and effect). However, any time you play any an Offensive Effect (see definition above), YOU MUST HAVE THE ATTENTION OF ALL OTHER PLAYERS. Before you play an Offensive Effect, you must announce your intention to do so (without specifying any details, including the name of the card used/played). In response to this announcement, any player may play cards and/or use abilities that only affect or target their own pack. Only when all players are ready do you play your Offensive Effect (you may choose not to).

There can be multiple Offensive Effects declared at the same time, but each player may only declare one Offensive Effect at a time. Resolve each Offensive Effect in the order players asked to play them. If players announce they wish to play an Offensive Effect at the same time, decide randomly which player goes first. Note that if combat starts, existing Offensive Effects declarations are ignored until combat resolves.

Bringing into play a Unique item (or once per game item), or using an ability which might put it into play, counts as an Offensive Effect if used in Open Play.

3.2.2 CANCELLATION

Abilities which cancel other abilities/cards interrupt the timing sequence and may always be played in response to the ability/card they are cancelling. You MAY cancel effects used during Closed Play because cancellation interrupts normal timing. If it is cancelled in this fashion, the cancelled card or ability never resolves. It IS still considered to have been played. Cancellers may also be used later, to cancel abilities or remove cards with permanent or ongoing effect, but cancelling this way is not retroactive: when abilities/cards are cancelled this way, effects they may have had previously are not reversed (e.g. cancelling *Eye of the Cobra* after the user has traded all the equipment from the Character they borrowed does not restore the equipment to the target).

You can respond to cancellation by cancelling the cancellation.

3.3 PLAYING CARDS

Rage does not use expendable resources. If you meet the requirements to play a card (e.g. a Combat Action or Gift), it does not count against Rage or Gnosis later in the turn.

Some cards require prerequisites before they may be played. If you successfully meet the requirements of a card and bring it into play, you do not have to keep meeting the requirements for the card to remain in play. For example, if you recruit an Ally that requires a Theurge in your pack and the Theurge later dies, the Ally does not leave the pack. Likewise, if a creature's Gnosis drops below the Gnosis requirement of a Fetish/Bane Fetish, the Fetish/Bane Fetish continues to work.

Where cards list multiple possible prerequisites separated by commas you need only meet ONE of those requirements. If a Gift lists users as "Theurge, Child of Gaia" you only need to be a Theurge OR a Child of Gaia. You don't need to be both.

Cards in Rage do not have "card memory". Each card is independent of any other copies of that card, either in play or played previously. A card which can only be played once per game can still only have one copy of it played per game, but a card which has a one-use ability (e.g. *Don Campisi*) may use its ability even if an earlier copy of the card has already done so. Similarly, if you use an effect that copies the text of a card or clones a card with a one-use effect, the copy/clone may still use that ability even if the card it copied/cloned has already used that ability.

Likewise, abilities that target one copy of a card only affect that copy - if you play a *Nemesis* on *Golgoth* and *Mamu*, it only affects one distinct copy of each, not all *Golgoths* and *Mamus* in play!

3.4 CARD SUPREMACY AND VERSIONS

When the text on a card conflicts with these rules, the card takes precedence. These rules are a simple skeleton for the game's mechanics; the cards are the special circumstances that allow you to break the rules (temporarily).

The most recently produced version of a particular Rage card (not including those produced for Rage Across Las Vegas) is considered correct. Any errata is considered to replace or supplement the most recent printing of the card.

Sidebar: Can't vs Must

In general, "Cannot" and "Will not" take precedent over "Can", "May", and "Must".

For example, if something says a character can't be Alpha and then a later effect says it must be Alpha is applied, it can't be Alpha. This does not actually cancel the second effect. It's there, but can not do anything. So if they were both ongoing effects and the first one was cancelled, the second one would then come into play.

The order they were played in is not relevant, the can't/won't effect takes priority.

However, if two effects clash but do not fall under this rule (e.g. two creatures must take the last alpha action), the effect which resolved last takes precedence. If neither rule applies, decide randomly.

See also: Umbral Combat & Forced Attacks

Sidebar: "My Character plays..."

Rage was derived from a roleplaying game and it shows in terminology. Although clearly all cards are played by players, when a card requires a creature to meet its requirements before it can be played, that creature is deemed to play that card. Specifically, all cards are considered played by a member of your pack except non-Totem events, Prey and cards played by Prey.

Similarly, some cards say "you" do something. Very often, especially on Combat Actions, it refers to the creature playing the card (generally we don't encourage our players to "tear some fool in half").